of the main program window. This interface has a single function—configuring a scan. Here the scope of the scan can be set, along with the type. Archives like ZIP or RAR files can be excluded from the scan if needed. One notable absence in Avast!'s arsenal is the scan scheduler, which one should consider a basic requirement.

Avast!'s Resident Protection controls

The program's options are available from the context menu of the System Tray icon. Under the Program Settings link, different aspects of the program's behaviour can be configured. Avast! supports different modes of informing the user about a virus detection—through SMTP or MAPI e-mail, through ICQ or MSN Messenger Instant Message, or via a direct alert to a printer. These settings can be made under the Alert link.

Avast! has options for configuring even what it should do during IM sessions

The On-Access Protection link allows controlling the behaviour of the many real-time scanning modules currently active.

Clicking on the Details button at the bottom allows each module to be individually configured. Under the Instant Messaging link, the level of security desired can be set, or a custom level can be set by clicking on the Customize button, under which the different networks that need to be monitored can be set.

Similarly, under the Internet Mail link, the level of security can be set or customised. Under the customisation options, rules to